

NWFP Management Prescription & Marketing for Luchu Shamong Tshogpa



Plan Period July 2014 – July 2019(Five Years)

Doteng Gewog

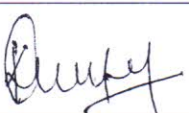
Paro Dzongkhag

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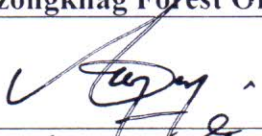
1. Approval Sheet

Name of NWFP Management & Marketing Group	Luchu Shamong Tshogpa
Dzongkhag	Paro
Gewog:	Doteng
Village(s)	Luchu
Number of Households	219
Plan period	2014 to 2019

Compiled by:

NWFP chairman	Gewog Forest Extension Officer
Signature: 	Signature: 
Name: KARMA CHOEDEN	Name: DORJI
Date: 4/8/2014	Date: 4/8/2014

Submitted by:

Dzongkhag Forest Officer
Signature: 
Name: AKGYI DORJI
Date: 4/8/2014

Approved by:

Chief Forest Officer
Signature: 
Name: Kaka Tshompa
Date: 4/8/2014

CP & Forest Division
Paro Forest Division

2 Background

Doteng gewog has total area of 193.1 sq. km of which 24640 acres are covered by forest and it lies in the north of the Dzongkhag. The gewog shares its boundary with *Dopshari* gewog in the south, in the west *Lamgong* gewog, in the north-west Tsento gewog and in the east Hungrel gewog. The gewog also shares the Dzongkhag boundary with *Thimphu* Dzongkhag in the north east. *Doteng* gewog has an altitude ranging from 2350-3550 meters above sea level.

Luchu Shamong Tshogpa, group formed for collection and marketing of mushroom is located in *Doteng* Gewog under the jurisdiction of *Paro* Dzongkhag. Approximately 825.5 acres of State Reserved Forest has been identified potential for collection of mushroom. After the series of consultative meeting with the farmers of *Luchu*, 21 households initially submitted for forming a management group. The *Tricholoma* mushroom is collected by the community of *Luchu* communities for its commercial value. Due to the increasing population and unhealthy method practiced during harvesting, the people of *Luchu* realized that unless they undertake some prior management measures for mushroom, there are chances of getting the said mushroom depleted which will hamper the income source in long term perspective, besides threats to other biodiversity.

3 The Management objectives of *Luchu Shamong Tshogpa* are as follows:

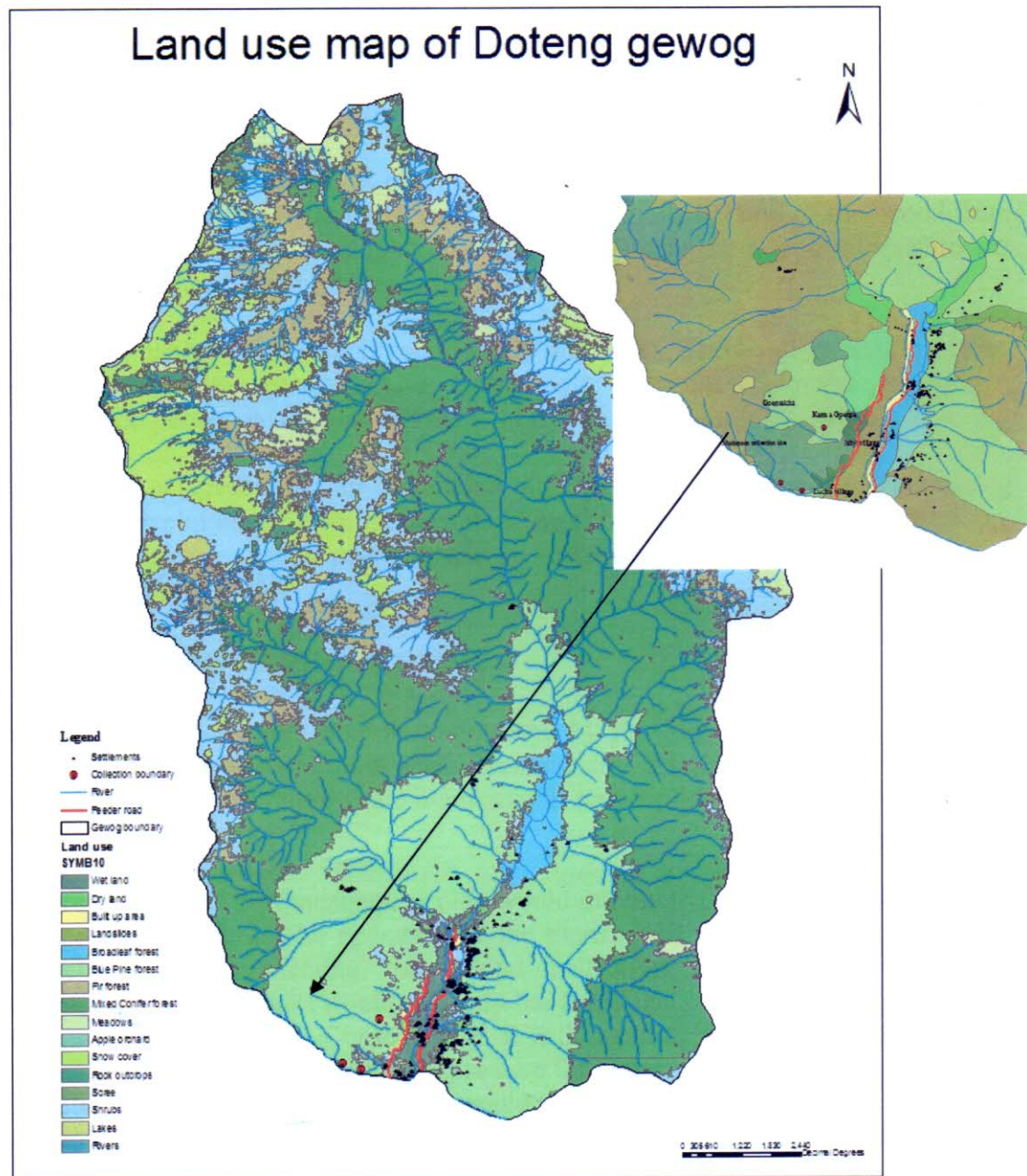
- Sustainable use and management of resources (Mushroom)
- Protect illegal harvesting of products by non members
- Enhance easy access to market through group
- To improve the productivity and quality through managing the habitat for consistent growth of mushroom.

4. MAP

Map 1: Google Map of Mushroom growing sites



Map 2: Location Map of Mushroom growing sites



6. General information on the Mushroom Habitat

The Sangay Shamu well known for its market value and there for the good income source of the people of Luchu communities over the years is found to be growing in the natural forest at an elevation ranging from 2500 to 3700m above sea level. The forest composition includes Blue pine, Oak, Rhododendrons, *Pieris*, *Lyonia*, Spruce and Hemlock. Other types of mushrooms like *Cantherellus cibarus*(*Sisi shamu*), *Auricularia Aauricula*(*Jili namcho*), *Russula delica*(*Gashamu*) *Ramaria botrytis*(*Jichu kangru*) and *Gypsy*(*Dhungshingshamu*) are also grown in the habitat.

The profuse natural regeneration of blue pine indicates good condition of forest that the forest stock will remain intact in long run. The grazing and collection of fuel wood from the area is very minimal and negligible and does not hamper the habitat of mushrooms owing to long distance from the village and settlements.

The mushroom habitat is also the home to many wild lives. The Sambar, Barking Deer, Jungle Foul, Pheasants, sparrow, Dove, Rats, Eagle, Butterflies, Thrushes, Squirrel, , Wild Pigs, wood pecker etc are some of the wild lives found in the habitat areas.

The habitat is at great risk for extinction due to open access to the increasing collectors/over exploitation. With the advent of legal frame works of the NWFP group, the resource would be protected and managed on sustainable manner.

7. Problems and opportunities

As per the annual collection records maintained by the local buyers, the production showed decline trend over the past years. Nonetheless, it is likely that the production would decline in the near future if the management prescriptions are not followed as per the plan.

The implementation of the management plan would minimize the inflow of the outsiders harvesting the mushroom. The operation of the plans which is for the next five years would help towards protecting the habitat collectively. In addition, the strict implementation of the by-laws would certainly bar the illegal collectors from entering the area for mushroom collection. Consequently, it will create opportunities for the member to have increased production and quality produce for better market. The income through the collection and trading of mushroom would be one of the rural vibrant sources of income provided no unexpected natural disaster/epidemic occurs in the near future.

8. Description of NWFPs

Table 1: Brief description of NWFPs for commercial harvesting:

NWFP name	Harvesting area(s)(name)	Parts harvested	Use purpose (traditional & others)	Harvesting season(months)	Estimated quantity that can be collected*
<i>Tricholoma matsutake</i> (Sangay Shamu)	-Gangbhum -Chuphakha -Bangayzhoe -Laptshakha -Taridasa -Yaktasa - Lamchochou -Janatsa	Harvested whole part	Curry, soup, fried curry, medicinal value, barbeque,	1 st August-15 th October	300kg/year
Sisi Shamu	-Kateyseychu tshu chey and lo dophu yar chey.	Whole part	Curry	July-September	500 kg/year
Others (Jichukongru, Ba shamu, Dungshing shamu, Ga shamu etc)	-Kateyseychu tshu chey and lo dophu yar chey. Tshapheykot o (Dungshing shamu) Goensa sham (Ba shamu)	Whole part	Curry	July-September	300 / year

*: Assumption on past year's collection

9. Harvesting Prescription

Table2: Harvesting prescriptions for sustainable harvesting:

NWFP species	Harvesting prescription for sustainable harvesting
<i>Tricholoma matsutake</i>	Avoid harvesting undersized mushroom (less than 7.5 cm in length or height), avoid disturbances of habitat, avoid use of plastic containers and bags in transportation, use cane/plastic baskets with holes, avoid cuttings of branches and trees, harvest in stipulated time frame, avoid littering specially with non-degradable
<i>Sisi shamu</i>	Avoid harvesting undersized mushroom, avoid disturbances of habitat, avoid use of plastic containers and bags in transportation, use cane/plastic baskets with holes, avoid cutting branches and trees, harvest in stipulated time frame, avoid littering specially with non-degradable

<i>Others</i>	Avoid harvesting undersized mushroom, avoid disturbances of habitat, avoid use of plastic containers and bags in transportation , use cane/plastic baskets with holes, avoid cutting of branches and trees, harvest in stipulated time frame, avoid littering specially with non-degradable
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10 Marketing and sales plan

Table3: Marketing and sales plan

NWFP	Potential market	Estimated quantity for sale per season (unit)	Expected price per unit	Deduction for Payment to Committee members(Chairman, Accountant and resoop	Remarks
<i>Tricholoma matsutake</i>	Local exporters or within members	300kgs	Nu.700/kg	Nu. 50/kg from Grade A and Nu.25 from Grade B mushroom	Deducted amount after payment to the committee members will be deposited to group account
<i>Sisi shamu</i>	Local exporters or within members	500kgs	Nu.380	Nu. 25/kg	
<i>Others</i>					

11 Annual work plan for five years

Activities	1 st Year	2 nd Year	3 rd Year	4 th Year	5 th Year	Remarks
1. Patrolling during peak fire season and harvesting season	20 th July	20 th July	20 th July	20 th July	20 th July	
2. Mushroom sample collection	20 th July	20 th July	20 th July	20 th July	20 th July	
1. Harvesting of Mushroom	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	
2. Notification	July	July	July	July	July	
3. Mushroom sale agreement	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	1 st August – 15 th October	

12 Monitoring and Evaluation

Luchu Shamong Tshogpa is responsible to monitor and evaluate whether the implementation of the activities are in line with the management plan. The monitoring and evaluation shall be done through NWFP group meetings and draw needful solutions to correct the lapses. In addition, the GFEO along with the Territorial Division and Dzongkhag Forestry staff will regularly monitor the group.

In the last year of this management plan in collaboration with DzFS an evaluation will be conducted and recommendations will be integrated in the next management plan.

BY-LAWS

1. Membership Arrangement

Any willing person holding house number, thram and census registered in the Gewog will have the opportunity to become the member of Luchu Shamong Tshogpa in the near future. The new member should in the first instance, submit an application to the Management Committee. The new member shall be considered as the member of the NWFP group only after completion of five year management plan upon approving by the management committee through payment of expenditures made by the earlier member during five year period.

Leaving membership on genuine ground or with lost of interest will not be compensated from the accumulated group fund. The member willing to withdraw from the group will have to draw an agreement with NWFP group. Replacement or substitution of membership and re-entry will not be entertained under any circumstances.

2. Benefit sharing procedure (Equity)

- All the NWFP group members shall have equal access to collect the mushroom as per the directives and rules of the group.
- The collected mushroom will be gathered in a particular place(existing collection shed) and hand over to the mediator for further marketing of mushrooms
- None of the members shall play tricks/foul role while collecting and gathering the collected mushroom.
- From each household, only two collectors will be allowed to collect the mushroom from the designated area.
- From every member 10% of the mushroom sales (all types of mushroom) shall proceed to the CMMG fund.
- The fund generated from NWFP will be given first priority in the development of NWFP group. The fund will be utilized in the following activities:
 - Meet the expenses of the committee members for NWFP duties
 - Guest expenditures
 - Purchase of seals and stationary for NWFP group
 - Developmental activities within the village

3. Terms and reference for Management Committee

Sl.No.	TITLE	RESPONSIBILITIES	Compensation
1	Chairperson	i. Chair the meetings. ii. Sign the cheque jointly with the secretary. iii. Distribute the minutes of the meetings to relevant agency/organizations. iv. Call/coordinate the meetings when there are disputes among the group to mutually resolve the things. v. Explore the market avenues. vi. Keep close contact with the relevant offices through sound relationship. vii. Conduct annual and emergency meetings. viii. Coordinate the monitoring and review of the planned activities. ix. Send the sample to NMC, Yusipang to confirm collection timing.	Normal National Work Force wages will be paid for weighing and grading of mushroom. Sum of Nu.500 will be paid from group fund if happened to travel beyond village vicinity for the NWFP group reasons.
2	Treasurer	i. Deposit the fund into the CFMG account. ii. Report the status of the fund in the meetings iii. Officiate as Secretary in the absence of the same. iv. Keep up to date records.	Normal National Work Force wages will be paid for weighing and grading of mushroom. Sum of Nu.500 will be paid from group fund if happened to travel beyond village vicinity for the NWFP group reasons
3	Risup	i. Patrol the area during fire season and prior to allocated mushroom collection time. ii. Keep the CMMG management committee informed about the wrong doings in the area. iii. Attend the management committee meeting.	Nu. 500 will be paid to resoop during the patrolling of collection site. He/she will inform to chairman before and after visit to the site.
4	Observer	i. Auditing of the income and expenditures ii. To detect any misleading by the both executive members and members	iii.

Note: The committee members are responsible to maintain records of their travel dully verified by the Chairman. The payment shall be made through the contribution from the NWFP members.

4. Roles and Responsibilities of NWFP group members

- Any wrong doings/undesired activities happening in the area shall be reported immediately
- All the members have the equal rights over the utilization of the resource (mushrooms) and therefore bear equal responsibilities to protect them too.
- The community will have balanced right over the use of the fund generated.
- All members shall contribute equal manpower while required to carry out the work in the area.
- Bear the penalties/fine with regard to deviation or laxity in not honoring the collectively drawn Bylaws of the NWFP Plan.
- The general members of the association reserves the rights to keep an eye on the performances of the management committee. Any management committee member found guilty of misconduct would be expelled from the posts and elect eligible new member during the group meeting.
- They should know the overall activities envisaged in the group Plan.
- Provide helping hands towards the implementation of management plan and conflict management.
- While implementing the activities as per the annual work plan, each member will send individual whose ages are between 15 years and 55 years old.
- They shall protect and manage the mushroom habitat collectively.

5. Fees

- i. A sum of Nu.100.00 shall be charged as the registration fee to all the members in the first year and shall be ceased thereafter. Mushroom group member shall pay Nu.500.00 as annual membership fee.

6. Offences and Penalties

SL No.	Offences	Penalty
1.	Carrying mushroom in plastic bags & rain gears	Nu.50.00
2.	Collection or harvesting mushroom by members or outsiders before and after the set time period	Nu.1000.00 and confiscation of mushroom
3.	Harvesting of undersize mushroom	Nu.100.00 per piece
4.	Involvement of more than two collectors from each household	Nu.1500.00 per person and confiscation of mushroom
5.	Selling of mushroom to other buyers	Nu.2500.00 1 st time Nu.5000.00 2 nd time Nu.7500.00 3 rd time and terminate from group without any benefits.
6.	Absentees(meetings and works)	Nu. 500.00 for both executive and members
7.	Forest fire	As per FNCR for member and outsiders
8.	Feeling of trees without permit within mushroom collection site	As per FNCR for member and outsider

9.	Outsiders harvesting mushroom	Nu.500.00 per head and it will increase by Nu.500 if they repeat and confiscation of mushroom
10	Visitors(Tourist)	Nu. 2000 will be charge for the visit

However, the NWFP group will allow the government and the research agencies to conduct studies about the mushroom. The intended studies should not be for personal/individual benefits. The governmental institutions shall inform the NWFP group in writing about the intended research activities/studies without which the management committee shall not entertain.

7. Financial Arrangement (Funds)

Sources of fund for the CMMG

- a. Annual membership fee
- b. Registration Fee
- c. New membership fee
- d. Collection of fine/penalties
- e. Sale of mushroom (10% of sale amount from each member goes to group fund)
- f. Visitors(Farmers Study Tour from within the Dzongkhag and other dzongkhags and organizations)
- g. Community Mushroom tour
- h. Relevant projects.

8. Meetings

The whole NWFP group members will have two general meetings annually excluding the ad-hoc and emergency meetings. During such meetings at least 80% of member should be present and 2/3rd majority votes will be considered for decision making. The hall will deliberate on the following:

- Annual work plan and achievements
- Constraints and opportunities
- Fund status

The first general meeting (19th July) will focus more on the marketing strategies and reliable market whereas the second general meeting (16th October) of the year will stress on the fund and achievements as per the annual work plans followed by other miscellaneous issues.

9. Conflict Resolution

Any sort of conflict among the NWFP members confining to the Luchu Shamong Tshogpa shall be dealt as per the following sets of procedures:

- The conflict among the group members will be dealt by the management committee with the support of NWFP members.
- If in case the conflict is not being able to resolve at the management committee level, the case shall be forwarded to the Gewog Administration through the Gewog Forest Officer.
- The case shall be further forwarded to the Dzongkhag Forest Officer by the Gewog Administration if the case is not solved at the Gewog level.
- The Dzongkhag Forest Office upon guidance from the Dzongkhag Administration shall try to resolve the case. The case if unsettled at the Dzongkhag level would ultimately land in the District court wherein the same shall be dealt according to the law of the kingdom.

10. Roles and Responsibilities of other stakeholders.

10.1. Dzongkhag Forest Office

- Impart trainings to enhance capacity of the NWFP group
- Support study tours in collaboration with Social Forestry Division and Projects.
- Monitoring and evaluation of the activities.
- Facilitation during the review of the entire plan, work plans etc.
- Support while exploring the market avenues
- Assist in conflict resolution.

10.2. Territorial Division/PARK

- In line with the FNCR 2006, monitoring will be done on wild life, minerals in the collection area.
- Facilitation during the review of the entire plan, work plans etc.
- Issuance of permits and collection of royalty

10.3. Gewog Administration/GYT

- Provide support on the overall management aspects of the mushroom group.
- Assist in resolving the conflicts among the NWFP group members.

- Support in sourcing the funding.

10.4. National Mushroom Center (NMC)

- Support pertaining to training on collection techniques, packing of mushroom and on the use of effective implements.
- Organize mushroom tour within and outside the country for NWFP group management committee members.
- Suggest the size of the mushroom prior to the collection time.
- Decide the collection time and advise the NWFP group accordingly.
- Coordinate with the research centers like Bajo RC and Yusipang RC on any required support for the NWFP group.
- Conduct research on mushroom in the near future if the need be.
- Assist in marketing.
- Facilitate the group on pricing decision taking.
- Facilitation while reviewing the management plan.

10.5. Gewog Forestry Extension Sector

- Help the group in seeking the funding support.
- Assist the group on conflict resolution.
- Facilitate the group on reviewing of the management plan.
- Train the group in persistent waste management.

10.6. Bhutan Agriculture and Food Regulatory Authority (BAFRA)

- Inspection and certification of mushroom for export

11. Power of the Department

The Department of Forests has the power to monitor and take actions with regard to the overall activities of the mushroom collection group, if they are deviated for the rules of the government. In addition, the Department of Forests is empowered to:

- (1) take action against violators of the Act, Rules or Management Plan, regardless of whether requested by the NWFP group or not;
- (2) inspect, monitor, review the records of and otherwise supervise the activities of the NWFP group, and take action (including revocation of the NWFP group's certificate, where warranted under these Rules) against the NWFP group or any of its member who may be acting in violation of the provisions of the management Plan or any provisions under this chapter;
- (3) *Anything which is not covered by the management prescription and by-laws of Luchu Shamong Tshogpa, will govern by the FOREST AND NATURE CONSERVATION ACT OF BHUTAN, 1995 and FOREST AND NATURE CONSERVATION RULES OF BHUTAN.*

Dzongkhag Forestry sector in coordination with Division Forest Office and National Mushroom Centre imparting training to user group



Jepa and Jabji Luchu Tshogpa along with user group discussing on the traditional boundary



Jepa Tshogpa signing on the boundary demarcation agreement form.





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DOTENG GEWOG ADMINISTRATION



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RINPUNG DZONG, PARO

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29

7 2014

Boundary Demarcation

Name of NWFP group: LUCHU SHAMONG TSHOGPA

Date: 1/8/2014

Way point No.	Location/Name	Easting	Northing	Description	Remarks
01	Lodhophu	89°24'3.0"	27°28'16.2"	Jepa and Luchu sechu.	
02.	Phudroja base	89°24'39.4"	27°28'20.4"	Jepa and Luchu sechu.	
03.	Chera	89°25'06.7"	27°28'50.8"	Jepa and Luchu irrigation channel	
04.	Serto Kesa	89°24'58.6"	27°28'57.17"	Luchu and Jabji village boundary	
05	Chakhutkang	89°23'56.13"	27°28'17.75"	Luchu and Jepa village boundary.	

གོང་འཁོད་ས་ཚམས་ཚུ་ ང་བཅས་བཤམ་འཁོད་གཡུལ་གྱི་མི་མེད་ངོ་ཚབས་ཚུ་ཉམས་རུབ་ཐོག་ ས་ཚམས་དོ་ཚམས་བཀལ་བཀལ་མ་ཡིན།
 འདི་འབད་མ་ལས་ ང་ལས་མར་ ས་ཚམས་སྐྱོར་ཉེག་ས་འཛིན་ག་གི་ཡང་བཤད་ནི་མེད་པའི་ ལས་བྱང་ས་འབད་མ་དང་འབྲེལ་
 གཡུལ་མཚན་ག་གི་དོང་ས་ལས་ ས་ཚམས་སྐྱོར་ ཉེག་ས་བཤད་མ་ཐོན་ཚད་ ཁྲིམས་དང་འབའ་ གཞུང་ཁྲིམས་ལྟར་
 གྲག་ཕྱིད་ཁྱེ་ཡིན་པའི་ལས་བྱང་ས་གྲུབ། ཞེས་ གནམ་ལོ་ 2070 ལྷོ་པའི་ཚེས་ 9 ལ།

Boundary survey committee:



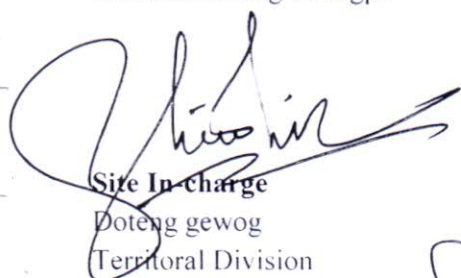
Chairman
Luchu Shamong Tshogpa



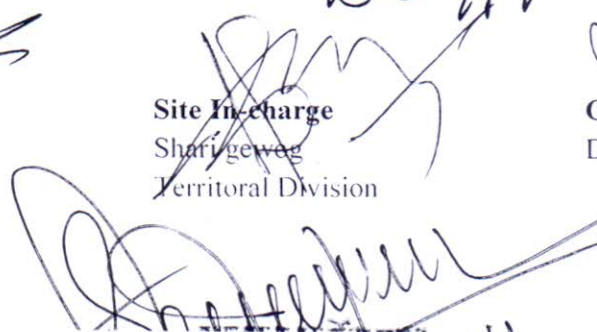
Tshogpa
Jeba chiwog
Dopshari gewog



Tshogpa
Jabji-Luchu chiwog
Doteng gewog
Jabje - Lukchoe
Doteng Geog
Pao



Site In-charge
Doteng gewog
Territorial Division



Site In-charge
Shari gewog
Territorial Division



GFE
Doteng gewog